JOB AID | CBCT 3D IMAGING

Quick Start: Reviewing a CBCT Scan in 5 Steps

A one-page reference for opening, viewing, measuring, and securely sharing a cone beam CT scan.

AUDIENCE
Dental front-office and clinical staff (assistants, hygienists, coordinators)

GOAL
Review a scan accurately and share it securely

THE 5 STEPS

1 Open the patient scan securely

- Log in with your own credentials. Never share a login or leave a session open.
- Confirm two patient identifiers (for example, full name and date of birth) before opening.
- Check the scan date and field of view to make sure it is the correct study.

2 Orient the views: axial, coronal, sagittal

Axial: top-down slices | **Coronal:** front-facing slices | **Sagittal:** side-view slices

- Use the reference lines (crosshairs) to link the views. Moving a line in one view updates the other two.
- If the head is tilted, use the viewer's reorientation or reset tool before reviewing anatomy.

3 Adjust slice position and contrast

- Scroll through slices in each plane to locate the region of interest.
- Adjust brightness and contrast (window/level) to separate bone, teeth, and soft tissue.
- Display changes affect only what you see. They do not alter the original scan data.

4 Measure and annotate a region

- Measure where the structure appears straight and full length; confirm in a second view.
- Add a short, clear label or note, then save so annotations stay with the study.
- Measurements support the dentist's review; diagnosis remains with the provider.

5 Export and share via a HIPAA-compliant link

- Export only what the recipient needs (selected images, a report, or the full DICOM dataset).
- Upload to the practice's approved HIPAA-compliant file-sharing platform, never regular email.
- Send a secure, expiring link to a verified recipient and record the share per office policy.

Common mistakes

- **Opening the wrong study:** checking only the name, not a second identifier.
- **Measuring on a tilted or single view:** distances can be distorted; verify in two planes.
- **Sharing by email or USB:** unsecured copies put patient data at risk.

Privacy check (HIPAA)

- Share the **minimum necessary** information for the purpose.
- Lock your screen whenever you step away.
- Verify the recipient before sending; use links with expiration and access controls.
- Never save scans to personal devices; report suspected breaches to your privacy officer.